

1. Present Perfect vs Past Simple

Summary: Use present perfect for unfinished time and past simple for a finished time.

Example: I have lived here for ten years. / I lived there for ten years.

2. Present Perfect Continuous

Summary: An action that started in the past and is still happening, with a visible result.

Example: She has been painting the kitchen all morning.

3. Past Perfect

Summary: The earlier of two past events, the 'past in the past'.

Example: When we arrived, the film had already started.

4. Future Continuous

Summary: An action in progress at a point in the future.

Example: This time tomorrow I will be flying to Lisbon.

5. Future Perfect

Summary: Something completed before a point in the future.

Example: By Friday we will have finished the report.

6. First Conditional

Summary: A real possible situation and its result.

Example: If it rains, we will stay inside.

7. Second Conditional

Summary: An imaginary or unlikely present situation.

Example: If I won the lottery, I would travel the world.

8. Third Conditional

Summary: An impossible past situation and its imagined result.

Example: If I had studied, I would have passed.

9. Mixed Conditionals

Summary: A past condition with a present result, or vice versa.

Example: If I had taken the job, I would be rich now.

10. Passive Voice Present

Summary: The object becomes the subject; the doer is optional.

Example: The letter is written by Maria.

11. Passive Voice Past

Summary: Past events in the passive emphasize what happened.

Example: The bridge was built in 1890.

12. Modal Verbs of Obligation

Summary: Must, have to and should for different strengths of duty.

Example: You must wear a seat belt.

13. Modal Verbs of Deduction

Summary: Must, might and can't for how sure we are.

Example: She must be at home; her car is here.

14. Defining Relative Clauses

Summary: Which/who that identifies the noun, no commas.

Example: The man who called is my uncle.

15. Non-defining Relative Clauses

Summary: Extra information about a known noun, with commas.

Example: My brother, who lives in Oslo, is a pilot.

16. Reported Speech

Summary: Telling someone what another person said, with a tense shift.

Example: She said that she was tired.

17. Indirect Questions

Summary: A question inside a statement, with statement word order.

Example: I wonder where they live.

18. Wish plus Past Simple

Summary: To regret or want a different present.

Example: I wish I had a car.

19. If only

Summary: A stronger wish, often with regret.

Example: If only I had known earlier.

20. Used to and Would

Summary: Past habits; would only for repeated actions.

Example: We used to play in the park.

21. Gerund or Infinitive

Summary: Some verbs take -ing, others take to, some both.

Example: I enjoy reading. / I want to read.

22. Bare Infinitive

Summary: After modals and let, make, help the to drops.

Example: Let me help you.

23. Comparatives and Superlatives

Summary: Comparing two or more things.

Example: This road is narrower than that one.

24. As as

Summary: Equality with an adjective or adverb between.

Example: He runs as fast as his sister.

25. Too and Enough

Summary: Too before an adjective means more than needed.

Example: The coffee is too hot to drink.

26. So and Such

Summary: So before an adjective, such before a noun phrase.

Example: It was such a nice day.

27. Although and Though

Summary: A contrast that can start or end a clause.

Example: Although it rained, we went out.

28. Despite and In spite of

Summary: A contrast followed by a noun or -ing.

Example: Despite the rain, we went out.

29. Because and Because of

Summary: Because takes a clause, because of a noun.

Example: We stayed because of the storm.

30. Linking Words of Addition

Summary: Moreover, furthermore and in addition add points.

Example: Moreover, the price is fair.

31. Linking Words of Contrast

Summary: However and nevertheless show a turn.

Example: However, the plan has risks.

32. Linking Words of Cause

Summary: Therefore and consequently give a result.

Example: It rained; therefore we stayed home.

33. Linking Words of Result

Summary: So and as a result close the chain.

Example: It rained, so we stayed home.

34. Articles a an the

Summary: A/an for one of many, the for a known one.

Example: I saw a cat. The cat was black.

35. Countable and Uncountable

Summary: Some nouns have no plural and take different quantifiers.

Example: We need more information.

36. Subject Verb Agreement

Summary: The verb agrees with the subject, not the nearest noun.

Example: The list of items is long.

37. Tag Questions

Summary: A short question tag checks or confirms.

Example: It's cold today, isn't it?

38. Prepositions of Place

Summary: In, on and at for position.

Example: The book is on the table.

39. Prepositions of Time

Summary: In, on and at for time expressions.

Example: We meet at noon on Monday.

40. Phrasal Verbs with Look

Summary: Look after, look for and look forward to.

Example: Please look after the house.

41. Phrasal Verbs with Get

Summary: Get up, get over and get along.

Example: I get up early on Mondays.

42. Active to Passive Conversion

Summary: Only transitive verbs can be passivized.

Example: Someone stole my bike. / My bike was stolen.

43. Question Formation

Summary: Auxiliaries move before the subject in questions.

Example: Where did you go?

44. Negation with Never

Summary: Never sits before the main verb.

Example: I never eat fast food.

45. Causative Have and Get

Summary: Have something done means someone else does it.

Example: I had my hair cut.

46. Reported Requests

Summary: Told me to for a request in speech.

Example: She told me to wait.

47. Purpose Clauses

Summary: To and so that express purpose.

Example: I study to learn English.

48. Time Clauses

Summary: When, while and before take present for future.

Example: When he comes, we will start.

End of the grammar handout.